

# Sweet Pointe Candy — What Your Website Will Be

The platform, the pages, and the foundations — decided on evidence, built to get found, and kept on the system you already run.

**The short version.** We build a **small, fast site with every foundation** — home plus the handful of pages that make money — and we **keep Lightspeed as your single source of truth** instead of migrating you to Shopify. Your register and inventory stay exactly where they are. On top of that we add the layer Lightspeed doesn't do on its own: the schema and structure that get you named in Google, Maps, and AI answers when someone asks "candy near me." You get a simple UI to run it. No double entry, no re-platform, no developer on speed-dial.

## The Platform Decision

You run **Lightspeed Retail** — it's your register, your inventory, your day. The real question isn't "which website builder," it's **how to get a modern, findable site without breaking what already works**. We looked at four paths.

| Path                                                             | SEO basics              | Schema / AI-answer        | Team-edit | Inventory sync                         | Cost / risk |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------|-----------|----------------------------------------|-------------|
| ① Lightspeed eCom (E-Series) + a GEO layer<br><i>recommended</i> | Strong<br><i>native</i> | Added<br><i>we inject</i> | Easy      | Native<br><i>one system</i>            | Low         |
| ② Marketing front end + Lightspeed store<br><i>fallback</i>      | Full                    | Full                      | Medium    | Native                                 | Med         |
| ③ Third-party sync bridge to another storefront                  | Varies                  | Varies                    | Medium    | Bridged<br><i>failure point</i>        | Med         |
| ④ Migrate to Shopify                                             | Full                    | Full                      | Easy      | Breaks<br><i>2 systems or drop POS</i> | High        |

**The finding:** Lightspeed's own eCom already covers the commerce SEO basics — clean URLs, an auto-generated sitemap, custom meta titles/descriptions, 301 redirects, and image alt text — and it keeps inventory synced to your POS as one system. Its one real gap is that it **doesn't add structured-data / schema on its own** — and schema is exactly what wins AI answers. So we build on Lightspeed and **inject the GEO layer ourselves**. If, once we're in, E-Series can't carry the custom pages and schema we need, we drop to the fallback — a fast marketing site for the get-found pages that links into your Lightspeed store for catalog and checkout. Either way, **you stay on Lightspeed**.

*Why not Shopify: re-platforming means either abandoning the Lightspeed POS your team already runs, or running two inventory systems that fight each other (double entry, sync conflicts). That's cost and risk a seven-week-old shop doesn't need — and it's the opposite of "small site, all foundations."*

Sources: Lightspeed — [Improving SEO for eCom \(E-Series\)](#) (x-series-support.lightspeedhq.com); [Lightspeed eCom](#) (lightspeedhq.com/ecom); [Lightspeed vs Shopify POS comparison](#) (technologyadvice.com); [Lightspeed Retail integration / SKUPlugs](#).

## The Site — Every Page Earns Its Place

Small doesn't mean thin. It means we build only the pages that capture real demand — each one on the full foundation, each with one clear job.

| Page                                   | What it's for                                                                                   | Primary CTA               | Phase      |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------|
| Home                                   | The destination + the 1932 heritage in one glance; sends people to the two money paths.         | Book a Party / Shop Boxes | 1          |
| Parties                                | Packages, photos, what's included, booking. Plan-ahead revenue; "candy buffet grosse pointe."   | Book / Inquire            | 1          |
| Gift Boxes                             | The three hero boxes, styled as gifts by occasion. Lead with the occasion, not the ingredients. | Order a Box               | 1          |
| Corporate & Realtor Gifting            | The underpriced lane: logo boxes, local delivery, net terms. High-ticket, repeat.               | Request a Quote           | 1          |
| Visit                                  | Hours, map, parking, the Kercheval block. Feeds Google Business Profile + "near me."            | Get Directions            | 1          |
| About / 1932                           | The Lee's Grocery heritage — trust + the "retro candy michigan" nostalgia search.               | Visit / Follow            | 1          |
| FAQ hub                                | Engineered for AI extraction — plain-language answers AI engines lift verbatim.                 | (citation asset)          | 1          |
| Full catalog / checkout                | Stays in Lightspeed eCom, synced to inventory. Not rebuilt.                                     | Add to Cart               | Lightspeed |
| Shipping / subscriptions / gift guides | Deferred — added once the local system is proven.                                               | —                         | Later      |

## The Foundations — Day-One Checklist

- ✓ **GA4 + Search Console** verified and tracking the four conversions
- ✓ **Google Business Profile** completed, categories Candy Store + Event Venue, weekly posts, monthly photos
- ✓ **Consistent NAP** (name/address/phone) everywhere — small mismatches cut AI trust
- ✓ **Clean URLs** + auto sitemap + robots (native to Lightspeed eCom)
- ✓ **LocalBusiness / CandyStore schema** — the core identifier AI reads
- ✓ **Product + Offer schema** on boxes; **Event schema** on parties/seasonal
- ✓ **FAQPage schema** on the FAQ hub and key pages
- ✓ **Core Web Vitals** — mobile-first, fast; ~80% of visits are phones
- ✓ **Review engine** — request within 24h, respond within 48h

*The schema stack is the piece Lightspeed doesn't do natively — it's injected as JSON-LD. It's low-cost, mostly one-time, and it's what turns "a nice site" into "the store the AI names."*

Sources: [How local businesses show up in Google AI Overviews 2026](#) (oatmarketing.com); [Structured Data for AI Search — schema guide 2026](#) (stackmatix.com); [Local Business Schema Markup Guide 2026](#) (techcognate.com).

## Getting Named in AI Answers (GEO)

Over half of searches now trigger an AI summary that cites a handful of sources. If you're not structured to be retrieved, you're invisible in the research phase. The fix is cheap and mostly one-time.

- **Answer first.** A direct 40–80 word answer under each page's headline — AI lifts concise blocks.
- **Question-shaped headings.** "How much is a candy birthday party in Grosse Pointe?" mirrors how people actually ask.
- **The FAQ hub** built from real customer questions — allergies, party pricing, delivery radius, corporate minimums, retro finds.
- **Facts AI can cite** — prices, capacities, hours, the 1932 story, the service area — in plain, extractable text.

**Baseline to beat.** Today, asking ChatGPT / Google AI / Perplexity "best candy store near Grosse Pointe," "book a kids' candy party near Detroit," or "unique local corporate gift under \$50" does not reliably name Sweet Pointe. That's the gap this closes — and it's measurable: we re-run the same prompts after launch.

*We will not fabricate a visibility score — the baseline is established by running the real prompts at kickoff and recording who gets named.*

## How It Gets Built — And Who Runs It

We build the site with an **agentic workflow** — faster and cheaper than a traditional agency drag — and hand your team a **simple UI**, not a codebase.

| Job                                                            | Who does it    | How                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Site build, schema, foundations                                | FRDT           | Agentic build pipeline; you approve a mockup first. |
| Change a price, swap a photo, publish a box or a party package | Your team      | Simple UI — no developer, no ticket.                |
| Post to social, add a seasonal box                             | Your team      | Templates + the same UI.                            |
| Inventory + checkout                                           | Lightspeed     | Stays the source of truth; syncs automatically.     |
| Schema / tracking / GEO upkeep                                 | FRDT → handoff | Set once, documented in the playbook.               |

## What Ships in 8–10 Weeks vs. Later

### Ships now

- ✓ The 7-page small site on the full foundation
- ✓ Lightspeed integration (single source of truth)
- ✓ Schema + GBP + tracking + FAQ hub
- ✓ Two conversion paths + gifting inquiry
- ✓ The team UI + playbook

### Deferred (proven first)

- National shipping ecommerce
- Subscription boxes
- Gift-guide content hubs at scale
- Paid media / retargeting

**Bottom line for Dave:** a small, fast website that keeps your register where it is, gets you found when the neighborhood — and the AI — goes looking for candy, and hands you a simple way to run it. Built in weeks, not months. Yours to keep.